

14 SSDs vs HDDs? SSDs win. Hands down

Given a choice between a 500GB hard disk drive or a 128GB SSD, we'd suggest you blindly choose the SSD option. The reason for this is simple, SSDs are more sturdy and more secure (TRIM) and will dramatically boost your battery life. External HDDs are cheap and numerous, cloud storage and streaming also mean that you don't need to lug around that much data anymore.



15 Memory woes: You'll never get what's advertised

This is a very important point to consider, especially if you're planning on picking up a budget smartphone. The Canvas HD for example showcases 4GB built-in storage but lets you use a mere 1.77GB. Native apps that can't be removed and more importantly, the OS itself, will hog the free memory. You'll need to do a mental check of your data needs, add 2-4GB to that and purchase a phone accordingly. Having a microSD expansion slot is always a huge bonus.



16 Don't get swayed by the Focus Points

If more focus points meant better focusing then we'd never miss a shot in. What really matters is the area covered by those focus points and 45 focus points in the middle of the viewfinder means nothing vs. 11 scattered points. Also, it's the number of cross-type points that matter since they're the ones that do most of the hard work.



17 Screen quality – capacitive or resistive

The touchscreen is the most important component of a tablet as it's your primary way of interacting with the device. While purchasing a tablet, always make sure it has a capacitive display instead of a resistive one. There are a variety of grades when it comes to capacitive displays. The good ones are smooth to interact with whereas the lower quality ones feel rough and don't respond well. It's always best to try the device for yourself before purchase.



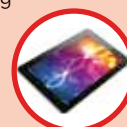
18 Understand what makes a camera good in low light

We asked salespersons across various big retail chains to show us cameras that were good in low-light and none of them really knew. Rule of thumb, don't trust the salesman. Read up about the various types of sensors and other factors that go into low-light photography.



19 Manufacturers matter. Who else is going to provide support?

Companies like Samsung, Sony, Asus and more are trusted brands and people find it easier to purchase products from these brands as the after sales service is usually provided by the electronic store where you bought your device, or, these brands have their dedicated service centres. But when it comes to brands like Lava, Micromax, iberry, Wicked-Leak and more, you may want to be careful before putting your money down. Make sure there is a service centre near you. One visit should tell you how user friendly the place is. We have heard instances where Micromax has great service in one city and really bad in another.



20 Slim and sexy with a catch

The current gen slim and light laptops and ultrabooks come with a promise of minimal compromise on performance, and technically they do offer a truck load of performance and battery efficiency for their size and weight. The reduction in price does come at a price though. Slimmer, compact machines end-up cutting down on the cooling system by reducing the fan size and the heat sink area, putting more pressure on fewer components. The end result can be a laptop that will scald your legs annoy the hell out of you with a noisy fan. Of course, some laptops are better designed than others, but you'll need to check for yourself before you pick one up. Your lap will thank you.



21 Buying from abroad? What about the warranty?

There's something appealing in getting stuff from abroad at a discount. Remember that you might sacrifice the warranty though. Confirm with the manufacturer if you're worried.



22 Wi-Fi, gps? What's it doing on my camera?

These gimmicky features makes us want to punch a baby seal. You don't REALLY need Wi-Fi and GPS on your phone. Both the features drain your battery than a parched camel drinking at an Oasis. Its not like you can't upload your images when you get home and onto a computer. An hour's worth of delay isn't going to kill you is it? Also, you do know where you took your shots right?

